

Vercel Deployment Fix - nextjs_space Issue

Date: December 14, 2025

Status:  FIXED

Commit: bb8758b

Problem

Vercel deployments were failing with the error:

```
Error: ENOENT: no such file or directory, stat '/vercel/path0/nextjs_space'
```

This error was preventing all deployments, including critical email fetching fixes.

Root Cause

A symbolic link named `nextjs_space` existed in the project root directory:

```
nextjs_space -> /opt/hostedapp/node/root/app/node_modules
```

This symlink pointed to a local development path that:

1. Doesn't exist in Vercel's build environment
2. Was being tracked by git (mode 120000 indicates a symlink)
3. Caused Vercel's build process to fail when trying to access it

Solution

1. Removed the Symbolic Link

```
rm nextjs_space
```

2. Added to .gitignore

```
echo "nextjs_space" >> .gitignore
```

3. Committed Changes

```
git add .gitignore
git rm nextjs_space
git commit -m "Fix: Remove nextjs_space symlink causing Vercel deployment failures"
git push origin master
```

Verification

Local Build Success

The build was tested locally and completed successfully:

```
npm run build
✓ Build completed successfully
✓ All routes compiled without errors
✓ No references to nextjs_space in source code
```

Files Changed

- **Removed:** `nextjs_space` (symbolic link)
- **Modified:** `.gitignore` (added `nextjs_space` entry)

Impact

✓ Immediate Impact:

- Vercel deployments will no longer fail with ENOENT errors
- Build process runs from the correct root directory
- All email fetching fixes can now be deployed

✓ Prevention:

- `.gitignore` entry prevents future symlink tracking
- No source code references to `nextjs_space` directory
- Clean build configuration without local path dependencies

Next Steps

1. Trigger Vercel Redeploy:

- Go to Vercel dashboard
- Click “Redeploy” to trigger a fresh build
- The build should now complete successfully

2. Verify Deployment:

- Check Vercel build logs for success
- Confirm no ENOENT errors
- Test the deployed application

3. Monitor:

- Watch for any build warnings
- Verify all features work in production

Technical Notes

Why This Happened

The `nextjs_space` symlink was likely created during local development as a convenience shortcut to `node_modules`. However:

- Symlinks should not be committed to git for deployment
- They create environment-specific dependencies
- They break builds on platforms like Vercel

Best Practices

1. Never commit symlinks to git unless absolutely necessary
2. Use relative paths in configuration files
3. Keep .gitignore updated to exclude local development artifacts
4. Test builds in clean environments before deploying

Related Files

- `vercel.json` - Vercel build configuration (no changes needed)
- `next.config.js` - Next.js configuration (no changes needed)
- `package.json` - Build scripts (no changes needed)
- `.gitignore` - Updated to exclude `nextjs_space`

Commit History

```
bb8758b - Fix: Remove nextjs_space symlink causing Vercel deployment failures
700351d - Add comprehensive documentation for email fetching fix
7df2e79 - Fix: Email fetching functionality in admin dashboard
```

Success Criteria

- ✓ Local build completes without errors
- ✓ Symlink removed from repository
- ✓ .gitignore updated
- ✓ Changes committed and pushed
- ⌚ Vercel deployment succeeds (pending redeploy)
- ⌚ Application runs correctly in production (pending verification)

Conclusion

The `nextjs_space` symlink has been successfully removed from the repository. The build configuration is now clean and platform-independent. Vercel deployments should now proceed without the `ENOENT` error. A redeploy on Vercel will confirm the fix is complete.